

Postmortem INC-7473: payments-api intermittent DNS resolution failures

Date: March 2026. Duration: 51 minutes. Severity: SEV2.

Summary

Customers saw errors from payments-api for 51 minutes. The trigger was intermittent DNS resolution failures.

Timeline

09:12 alert fired. 09:20 incident declared. 09:51 mitigation applied.

Root cause

A change merged two days earlier removed a safety limit, so intermittent DNS resolution failures was able to build up unnoticed until peak traffic. Monitoring did not alert early because the threshold was set for the old traffic pattern.

Contributing factors

- The runbook pointed to a dashboard that had been renamed.
- The canary stage was skipped for a config-only change.

Action items

- AI-266: restore the safety limit and add a regression test.
- AI-479: update the alert threshold to the new traffic pattern.
- AI-463: never skip the canary, including for config changes.